their noses. After the arrest of Private Manning, it became obvious that, even with no evidence of a connection between us, the US authorities were acting as if there were, and they had me under surveillance. Under those conditions, I realised it wasn't safe for me to be at home in Australia, where I was visiting. The priority for me, quite honestly, was not my own safety – I recognised, even then, that forces would always be after me, and they would trap me in some way or another before long. My concern was for the work that WikiLeaks had been focusing on: we had a number of large releases being prepared, and I was afraid we were approaching a 'publish or perish' situation. We have always had a mechanism at WikiLeaks that ensures that if we are unable to continue, then all the material will be released at once. But I wanted to avoid that: the cache of documents we hold is so large and so deserving of individual assessment and discrete publication that I wanted to feed the material out with due carefulness.

It was obvious I had to come back to Europe, so I arranged to be invited to give a talk on censorship at the European Parliament, and I travelled there via Hong Kong, avoiding Singapore or Thailand, where there would have been a greater willingness to respond to US calls to have me seized. (I've found it's always wise to travel on a political invitation, guaranteeing a fuss if you don't reach your destination.) There were a number of MPs there, as well as friends from Iceland, talking about the Iceland Modern Media Initiative, the movement behind our attempt to found an openness haven. I spoke about the increasing business of newspapers removing material from online archives, responding to gag orders, and so on. And I bumped into the *Guardian*'s man in Brussels, an affable sort who was receptive to what I was saying. I told him there were a number of upcoming publications that might be of interest to the paper. He went off, and I soon heard from a special investigations reporter on the paper, who said he wished to come from London to meet and discuss the proposal.

We had always envisaged the material we had on Afghanistan and Iraq being divulged through several established publications. That seemed the right way. It wasn't about single documents and single stories, but a whole slew of stories and hundreds of thousands of documents. We judged it would have the necessary impact only if they were published in an ambitious way, by people who could attach their own researchers and journalists to make sense of the material. We never pretended to understand, or even be in a position to read, every document in these massive caches,